1974) who was posted in the CGI as head of chancery (HOC) and consul in charge of economic relations. We are both from Patiala and our families were known to each other.

I had by that time seen through the game the 1 Akbar Road group was playing. I cryptically told K.C., 'These people are using Sikh officers to further their own interests.' I told him he should be careful and not do anything which he would regret later on. When he asked me to explain what I had just said, I replied that I would do that at an appropriate time in the future. K.C. Singh later served as India's ambassador to the UAE and Iran and retired as secretary in the Ministry of External Affairs. We would meet at the Delhi Golf Club often. But I only got around to speaking to him at length on the phone on 26 May 2020, specifically to know more about his experience of working as deputy secretary with President Zail Singh during the November 1984 anti-Sikh pogrom in Delhi. He still remembered what I had told him at New York in September 1983. [2]

During Indira Gandhi's visit I decided to hang around the hotel lobby and other venues while she met with the Indian press and persons of Indian origin, and also focus on the expected protest outside the UN building on 28 September. That day I reached the UN building about half an hour before the session was to start. I walked around the UNGA hall and other adjoining areas, including the Security Council wing, to ensure that there was no suspicious person or activity. That was out of sheer habit, as the R&AW officers were not supposed to look after the PM's physical security, which was the responsibility of Ratan Sahgal and his team from the Intelligence Bureau and, of course, the local security agencies, including the New York Police Department and the FBI, in close cooperation with each other.

After spending about ten minutes inside the UN building, I came out and saw two buses full of Sikhs and bearing Canadian number plates, parked some distance away, to the left of the entrance to the UN building. There were some policemen keeping a watch over them. They had cordoned off the area where the buses were parked with a tape running across the road. As there was still some time for Indira Gandhi's arrival, I went to meet the occupants of the two buses. Kuldip Singh Sodhi was not among them.